

Every organization says "bring your whole self to work." But that advice is wrong.

Most leaders I work with are not struggling because they are hiding who they are. They are struggling because they have been told their natural mode of operating should be enough for every room they walk into. When it is not, they feel like something is wrong with them.

There is nothing wrong with you. You are just being asked to lead from a different version of yourself than the one that feels comfortable.

That is not inauthenticity. That is a skill you can learn.

Authenticity is not about being who you are. It is about showing up how you want others to see you. The leaders who figure this out stop waiting to feel ready and start choosing who to show up as. Then they practice that version until it becomes natural.

You do not have to be yourself at work. You have to be intentional.

If you have felt like you are playing a role at work, what version of yourself are you actually choosing to practice?

#leadership #techleadership #leadershipdevelopment